Regis University
College for Professional Studies
School of Computer and Information Sciences

SYLLABUS

COURSE NUMBER: CIS 318

COURSE TITLE: Ethics for Information Technology Professionals

Course Description

Focuses on ethical problems that arise in the Information Technology world. Covers the areas of IT crime, privacy, intellectual property, software development and employer/employee issues. Introduces the codes of ethics for various IT professional associations and organizations.

Course Prerequisites

None

Course Overview

This course focuses on ethical problems that arise in an information technology setting. The course emphasizes the individual decision-maker in the entry-level position as well as at the managerial level. The course studies the various philosophical and social/psychological decision systems that managers and employees alike can use to resolve ethical problems.

Ethics can be a very complex and contradictory concept to learn and study. Many individuals spend their lifetimes exploring ethics and its application in society. This course is an introductory course in ethics. The focus is on ethical concerns and issues related to the areas of Information Technology.

Course Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to achieve the following outcomes:

1. Identify and illustrate ethical theories and decision-making models, and relate these theories and models to ethics in computer science/information systems.
2. Describe and demonstrate knowledge of ethical codes and their relationship and impact on IT professionals.
3. Explain trade-offs between ethical issues and the need for computer security. Review privacy laws and explain the need for ethical behavior in protecting personal and business privacy.
4. Summarize freedom of expression laws and identify issues associated with freedom of expression and information technology. Explain the term *intellectual property*,

illustrate how intellectual property is protected, and describe the role of information technology in both the exploitation and protection of intellectual property.
5. Identify the role of ethical issues in the development of computer software.
6. Understand the impact of information technology on productivity and quality of life, and identify ethical concerns regarding the digital divide.
7. Define social networks and explain ethical issues concerning their use in business.
8. Describe the need for ethical practices in business-related IT activities in the areas of outsourcing/off shoring, the environment, and reporting illegal/unethical behavior.

Course Materials and Resources, including Technology Tools

Required:

Reynolds, George W. (2012). *Ethics in Information Technology*. (4th edition) United States: Cengage Learning. Print ISBN13: 9781111534127 or ISBN10-: 1111534128.

Supplemental (online course only):

Adobe Acrobat Reader
RealPlayer (to watch the video presentations)

Method of Instruction

This course uses facilitated discussions, lectures, presentations, case studies, papers, group work, and group discussions.

Related Standards

Related Standards	
Program Outcomes	This course enables students to achieve the following program outcomes by the time of graduation:
	An understanding of professional, ethical, legal, security and social issues and responsibilities
	An ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences
	An ability to analyze the local and global impact of computing on individuals, organizations, and society
Regis Nine Educational Outcomes	
	Content Knowledge in Discipline
	Diverse Cultures, Perspectives, and Belief Systems
	Arts, Sciences, and Humanities
	Critical Thinking
	Communication
	Technology
	Ethical and Social Responsibility

	Leadership in Service to Others
	Lifelong Learning
Jesuit Themes - These are themes that are embedded as part of our interactions and instruction at Regis, but are not written in as activities	
	Magis, Finding God in All Things, Unity of Hearts and Mind, Contemplatives in Action, Care of the Whole Person, Men and Women for Others

First Week Assignment

- Reading Assignment: Reynolds – Chapter 1 & Additional Readings.

Course Overview Grid

Topic	Learning Topics	Activities	Reading Assignments	Written Assignments
1	Introduction to Ethics	• Introductions • Video discussion • Case Study discussion • Final Project Overview	• Chapter 1 • Additional Readings	Paper - Ethical Theories
2	Ethical Behavior of IT Professionals and Users	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapter 2 • Additional Readings	Work on Final Project
3	Computer & Internet Crime and Privacy	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapters 3 & 4 • Additional Readings	Paper - Computer Crime
4	Freedom of Expression and Intellectual Property	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapters 5 & 6 • Additional Readings	Work on Final Project
5	Software Development	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapter 7 • Additional Readings	Paper - Google in China
6	IT Impact on Productivity and Quality of Life	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapter 8 • Additional Readings	Work on Final Project
7	Social Networking	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion	• Chapter 9 • Additional Readings	Paper - Digital Divide
8	Ethics in IT Organizations	• Video discussion • Case Study discussion • Course Evaluation	• Chapter 10 • Additional Readings	Final Project due

Student Evaluation Grid

Assignment	Value (percent of overall course grade)
Forum/Participation	40%
Written Assignments	40%
Final Project	20%
TOTAL	**100 %**

Written Assignments

An important component of this course is the completion of written assignments. All written work is expected to meet undergraduate level standards. Assignments will be graded for content and for writing skills.

The Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association (APA) is to be used for written work in the College for Professional Studies. Research papers required in this and other courses are expected to follow APA guidelines. The facilitator will provide format, submission, and guidelines for the assignments.

APA Resources: http://www.regis.edu/regis.asp?sctn=ars&p1=ws

Participation

Because of the accelerated nature of the course, class participation is very important. Class participation/effort is important because we can all learn from each other. Your participation points can make a difference in the final grade. If the student doesn't participate during any given week, they will lose the participation points of that week.
Participation means:

1. a. Present in class every session (classroom)
   b. Present in the forum every week (online)
2. a. Effectively responds to questions from the facilitator (classroom)
   b. Regularly checks forum and post all required assignments/discussion questions/ items by the deadlines (online)
3. Contributes to classroom/forum discussions, etc.

Regis University Grading Scale

A	93 – 100	C	73 - 76
A-	90 – 92	C-	70 – 72
B+	87 – 89	D+	67 – 69
B	83 – 86	D	63 – 66
B-	80 – 82	D-	60 – 62
C+	77 – 79	F	59 or Lower

Attendance/Participation
Facilitator will provide specific attendance/participation policies in accordance with the official attendance policy of the School of Computer and Information Sciences.

Attendance Policy of the School of Computer and Information Sciences
Student participation is essential. Students are responsible for all material covered in each week. Students' interaction is central to the learning experience and imparts critical observations and knowledge to all concerned.

If a student misses more than one week of class participation without prior faculty approval, the facilitator may assign a failing grade.

Late Assignments/Assignment Revisions
Facilitator will provide specific late assignments/assignment revisions policies not to exceed the maximum official policy of the School of Computer and Information Sciences.

Late Assignments/Assignment Revisions Policy of the School of Computer and Information Sciences
Occasionally, work, health, and family obligations have priority over course work. If you experience these issues, please notify the facilitator in advance. If an assignment is due, please make every effort to submit your assignment on time. In the case of a negotiated absence or delay, assignments turned in by the agreed upon due date will receive full credit.

If you have not negotiated with the facilitator, assignments turned in late will be graded, then reduced by 25%. Assignments will not be accepted later than one week after due date.

Incomplete Grade
An incomplete grade is given at the discretion of the facilitator. A facilitator is not required to assign an incomplete grade. Each occurrence will be negotiated on an individual basis.

Incomplete Grade Policy of the College of Professional Studies
A grade of Incomplete or 'I" denotes that the required work for the course is incomplete due to unforeseen circumstances. Unforeseen circumstances mean, for example, that an accident, an illness, a death, or a major life transition has occurred. The student must have completed 75% of the course work to be eligible. This grade is awarded at the discretion of the instructor and is submitted with an alternate grade of "I/F."

A student must submit a written request to the instructor asking that an incomplete grade be assigned prior to the end of the term in which the course is taken. The course instructor will determine the length of time for course completion, and the remaining requirements to complete the course; however the maximum time for completion is the end of the following semester.

Faculty will notify students in writing of the approval/denial of their request and provide instructions and guidelines required to resolve the incomplete grade. If the course work is not completed by the end of the next applicable semester and a grade change form submitted by the instructor, the incomplete grade reverts to the alternate grade assigned by the instructor and is calculated in the grade point average.

Disability Statement:
Equal access to education means equal opportunity to learn in an academic setting. Under Section 504 of the 1973 Rehabilitation Act and the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, students with documented disabilities who are otherwise qualified have a right to equal access to classes at Regis University. If you have a documented disability requiring academic adjustments for this class, please contact the Director of the Office of Disability Services at **303-458-4941** for discussion of disability issues. Since accommodations are not retroactive, it is suggested that you contact the Disability Services Office as soon as possible; adequate lead-time may be required to receive accommodations, including review of appropriate documentation.

Academic Honor Code
Students and faculty of CPS are committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and assume full personal and professional responsibility for maintaining those standards. All members of the CPS community are to exhibit the qualities of honesty, loyalty and trustworthiness in all academic and clinical activities, holding themselves and each other accountable for the integrity of the learning community.

It is the responsibility of each student to review all aspects of the course syllabus and agree to adhere to this College for Professional Studies Academic Honor Code. In doing so, the student acknowledges that the work represented in all assignments and all examinations is his or her own and that he or she has neither given nor received unauthorized information. Furthermore, the student agrees not to divulge the contents of any assignment or examination to another student in any semester.

The CPS Academic Honor Code applies to any student in a CPS course, regardless of the student's home college or program, and will be enforced according to the policies and procedures of the Code. (In the cases of joint academic programs (e.g. National University of Ireland, Galway and Regis, ITESO and Regis, the academic integrity policies that comprise those joint program agreements apply and take precedence.)

Violations of academic integrity are taken very seriously in the College and include cheating, plagiarism, fabrication, collusion and other forms of academic misconduct. All violations will be reported with appropriate sanctions applied. All faculty have access to plagiarism detection software, which can be used with or without a student's knowledge in any CPS course.

Non-Public, Confidential or Proprietary Information Compliance
For class projects that relate to a student's employment, the student is responsible for complying with all applicable policies of the employer, including those related to non-public, confidential or proprietary information.